

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Public Economics, Structural Applied Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Behavioural Economics

## ACADEMIC PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Assistant Professor

HEC Paris –Paris, France- September 2023 – Present

## EDUCATION AND AWARDS

**PhD Economics** - University College London (2017 – 2023)

*Awards and fellowship:*

- ESRC Scholarship
- IFS Scholar

**MRes Economics** - University College London (2016 – 2017) - Distinction

*Awards and fellowship:*

- Gorman Scholar

**MSc Economics** - University College London (2015 – 2016) - Distinction

*Awards and fellowship:*

- Best Overall Performance prize
- Best Dissertation prize

**BSc Development and Economics** - The University of London External Program (2009-2012, Part-Time) – 2:1

**BSc Mathematics** - The University of Warwick (2002-2005) – 1st

*Awards and fellowship:*

- Award for Outstanding Academic Achievement

## WORKING PAPERS

*“Costly Attention and Retirement”*

*Revision invited by the Review of Economic Studies*

**Abstract:** In UK data, I document the prevalence of misbeliefs regarding the State Pension eligibility age (SPA) and these misbeliefs' predictivity of retirement. Exploiting policy variation, I estimate a lifecycle model of retirement in which rationally inattentive households learning about uncertain pension policy endogenously generates misbeliefs. Endogenous misbeliefs explain 43%-88% of the excessive (given financial incentives) drop in employment at SPA. To achieve this, I develop a solution method for dynamic rational inattention models with history-dependent beliefs. Costly attention makes the SPA up to 15% less effective at increasing old-age employment. Information letters improve welfare and increase employment.

*“The Intergenerational Elasticity of Earnings: Exploring the Mechanisms”, with Uta Bolt, Eric French, and Cormac O’Dea*

*Accepted at the Journal of Political Economy*

**Abstract:** Using data covering a single cohort's first 55 years of life, we show that most of the intergenerational elasticity of earnings (IGE) is explained by differences in: years of schooling, cognitive skills, investments of parental time and school quality, and family circumstances during childhood. To decompose the fraction of the IGE explained by each of these channels, we implement a multi-level mediation analysis combined with a latent factor framework that accounts for measurement error. Multilevel mediation analysis allows us to assess not only the *direct* effect of each channel on the IGE, but also its *indirect* effects working through the other channels, thus providing an in-depth understanding of the link between parents' and children's earnings. Of these channels, we show that the main driver of the IGE is increased levels of parental investments received by children of high-income parents early in their lives, which encourages greater cognitive development and lifetime earnings.

## *“Disentangling Risk Aversion and Intertemporal Substitution with Costly Attention”*

**Abstract:** Risk aversion to many is synonymous with the curvature of utility over consumption. Yet, when information is costly, agents have another reason to dislike risk: the cost of reducing uncertainty. I investigate how costly attention to learnable uncertainty impacts risk and intertemporal preferences by comparing two agents: one rationally inattentive and one standard and uninformed. Introducing rational inattention separates the elasticity of intertemporal substitution (EIS) from relative risk aversion (RRA) because the EIS is unchanged, but risk preferences are not. This is shown with extremely simple two-state two-period models and, as an application, I show this result may explain two finance puzzles.

*“Intergenerational Altruism and Transfers of Time and Money: A Life-Cycle Perspective”*, with Uta Bolt, Eric French, and Cormac O’Dea

## Revision invited by the Review of Economic Studies

**Abstract:** Parental investments in children can take one of three broad forms: (1) Time investments during childhood that affect child ability (2) Educational investments (3) Cash transfers in the form of inter-vivos gifts and bequests. Using panel data that covers a cohort of individuals from birth to retirement, we estimate a dynastic model of household decision-making with intergenerational altruism that nests a multi-period child production function and incorporates all three of these types of investments. We find that 28% of the variance of lifetime wages can already be explained by characteristics of the parents before individuals are born and 62% of the variance can be explained by age 23 characteristics of the individual. In terms of investments, we find evidence of dynamic complementarity between time and educational investments -- the returns to education are higher for high ability individuals. We find that this is a potentially important mechanism in perpetuating intergenerational outcomes, as borrowing constraints prevent low-income families from investing in education, thus simultaneously reducing the incentive to invest in time.

## CONFERENCES & SEMINARS

### *“Costly Attention and Retirement”*

|                                                                   |                                 |              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|--------------|
| • CEPR Economics of Longevity Conference                          | - University of Cambridge       | - July 2026  |
| • Futures of Utility and Risk (FUR)                               | - University of Alicante        | - June 2026  |
| • CEPR Household Finance Workshop                                 | - Bundesbank                    | - May 2026   |
| • Invited Talk                                                    | - CESifo Munich                 | - Mar. 2026  |
| • Expectations in Dynamic Marco Models                            | - University of Sydney          | - Dec. 2025  |
| • European Economics Association Congress                         | - University of Bordeaux        | - Aug. 2025  |
| • Econometric Society World Congress                              | - Econometric Society Seoul     | - Aug. 2025  |
| • Workshop on Subjective Expectations                             | - Nova SBE Lisbon               | - June 2025  |
| • Leuven Summer Event                                             | - KU Leuven                     | - May 2025   |
| • Paris Economics of Taxation Workshop                            | - CRED Paris 2                  | - March 2024 |
| • SEA Structural Microeconomics Sessions                          | - Southern Economic Association | - Nov. 2024  |
| • Foundations of Utility and Risk (FUR Conference)                | - University of Queensland      | - July 2024  |
| • Paris Macro Group (Workshops)                                   | - Paris School of Economics     | - Apr. 2024  |
| • BSE PhD Workshop on Expectations in Macroeconomics (Conference) | - Barcelona School of Economics | - Oct. 2022  |
| • University of Mannheim (Seminar)                                | - University of Mannheim        | - Oct. 2022  |
| • IIPF Annual Congress (Conference)                               | - University of Linz            | - Aug. 2022  |
| • NBER Summer Institute: Behavioral Macro (Conference)            | - NBER                          | - July 2022  |
| • RES junior symposium (Conference)                               | - University of Warwick         | - June 2021  |
| • CESifo Public Area (Conference)                                 | - CESifo                        | - Mar. 2021  |
| • Toulouse School of Economics (Seminar)                          | - Empirical Micro Workshop      | - Dec. 2021  |
| • University of Cambridge (Seminar)                               | - Empirical Micro Workshop      | - June 2021  |
| • Young Economist Symposium (YES Conference)                      | - University of Pennsylvania    | - Aug. 2020  |
| • Royal Economic Society Conference (RES Conference) CANCELLED    | - University of Belfast         | - Apr. 2020  |
| • NETSPAR (Conference)                                            | - Leiden                        | - Jan. 2020  |
| • From Transition Economics to Global Topics (Event Presentation) | - CERGE-EI Prague               | - Nov. 2019  |
| • Econometric Society European Meeting (ESEM Conference)          | - University of Manchester      | - Aug. 2019  |
| • Society of Economic Dynamics (SED Conference)                   | - University of Washington      | - June 2019  |
| • ENTER Jamboree                                                  | - University of Tilburg         | - April 2019 |

# Curriculum Vitae - Jamie Hentall MacCuish

## *"The Intergenerational Elasticity of Earnings: Exploring the Mechanisms"*

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|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------|
| • S&O Research Day                                            | - HEC                       | - May 2026  |
| • Econometric Society World Congress                          | - Econometric Society Seoul | - Aug. 2025 |
| • Dynamics of Inequality Across the Life-course (Conference)* | - Brussels                  | - Oct. 2021 |
| • TRends in Inequality: Sources and Policy (Conference)*      | - IIES Stockholm            | - Apr. 2021 |
| • Society of Economics of the Household (SEHO Conference) *   | - Boston University         | - May 2021  |

## *"Disentangling Risk Aversion and Intertemporal Substitution with Costly Attention"*

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|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------|
| • MRS International Risk Conference                | - Sawyer Business School    | - July 2025 |
| • D-TEA                                            | - Paris School of Economics | - June 2025 |
| • Foundations of Utility and Risk (FUR Conference) | - University of Ghent       | - June 2022 |

## *"Intergenerational Altruism and Transfers of Time and Money: A Life-Cycle Perspective"*

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|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------|
| • CEPR Human Capital Workshop                                | - Toulouse School of Economics  | - June 2026 |
| • Invited Talk Inter-Generational Rebalancing Conference     | - Institute for Fiscal Studies  | - May 2026  |
| • NBER Summer Institute: Inequality and Macroeconomics       | - NBER                          | - July 2025 |
| • Congress of the French Economic Association                | - ENS Paris-Saclay              | - June 2025 |
| • Paris Macro Group (Workshops)                              | - HEC                           | - May 2025  |
| • Dynamics of Inequality Across the Life-course (Conference) | - Online                        | - Dec. 2020 |
| • Barcelona Summer Forum (Conference)*                       | - Barcelona School of Economics | - Jun. 2020 |
| • Paris-London Public Economics (Conference)*                | - Paris School of Economics     | - Dec. 2019 |
| • Trends in Inequality: Sources and Policy (Conference)*     | - Institute for Fiscal Studies  | - Oct. 2019 |
| • Society of Economic Dynamics (SED Conference) *            | - University of Washington      | - Jun 2019  |
| • Royal Economic Society Conference (RES Conference) *       | - University of Belfast         | - Apr. 2021 |

\*Selected co-author presentations included

## OTHER PUBLICATIONS

- Joint VoxEU Publications [Why rich parents have rich children](#)
- DIAL Podcast [Why and how do rich parents have rich children?](#)

## SERVICE

- Referee: ERC Grants Application, The Review of Economic Studies, AEJ: Applied, Journal of Labour Economics, Journal of Public Economics, The Review of Economic Dynamics, The B.E. Journal of Macroeconomics
- Organiser: HEC ESD Seminar, UCL Applied Micro Reading Group

## TEACHING

**Econometrics** –HEC Master's in Economics and Finance – **2025-2026**

**Information and Expectations in the Macroeconomy** –HEC ENSAE Joint Research Master's– **2024-2025 & 2025-2026**

**L3 Microeconomics** –HEC Grande Ecole Programme– **2023-2024 & 2024-2025 & 2025-2026**

## SKILLS

Languages: Native English, Fluent Spanish, advanced French, and a basic knowledge of Portuguese.

IT Skills: Fortran, MPI, Matlab, R, C/C++, Stata, SQL, Regular expressions, Unix shell scripting, SAP skills ERP and Business intelligence systems, database administration, ABAP, Java, JavaScript, HTML, XML, inter-system interfaces.

## PREVIOUS PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**Senior SAP Technical Consultant**

**Ciber Australia** – Multinational ICT Consultancy Firm – Sydney, Australia - **April 2014 – August 2015**

**SAP Development Team Lead**

**Iveco Australia** – Commercial Vehicle Manufacturer – Melbourne, Australia - **August 2011 – April 2014**

## Curriculum Vitae - Jamie Hentall MacCuish

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### **Freelance SAP Consultant**

**Lion** – Australia and New Zealand's Leading Food and Beverage Company – Melbourne, Australia - **March 2011 – July 2011**

### **SAP Consultant**

**CSC Spain** - Multinational IT Consultancy Firm - Barcelona, Spain - **August 2007 – August 2010**

### **English Teacher**

**Comunica't** - Language School - Barcelona, Spain - **Oct. 2006 – July 2007**